

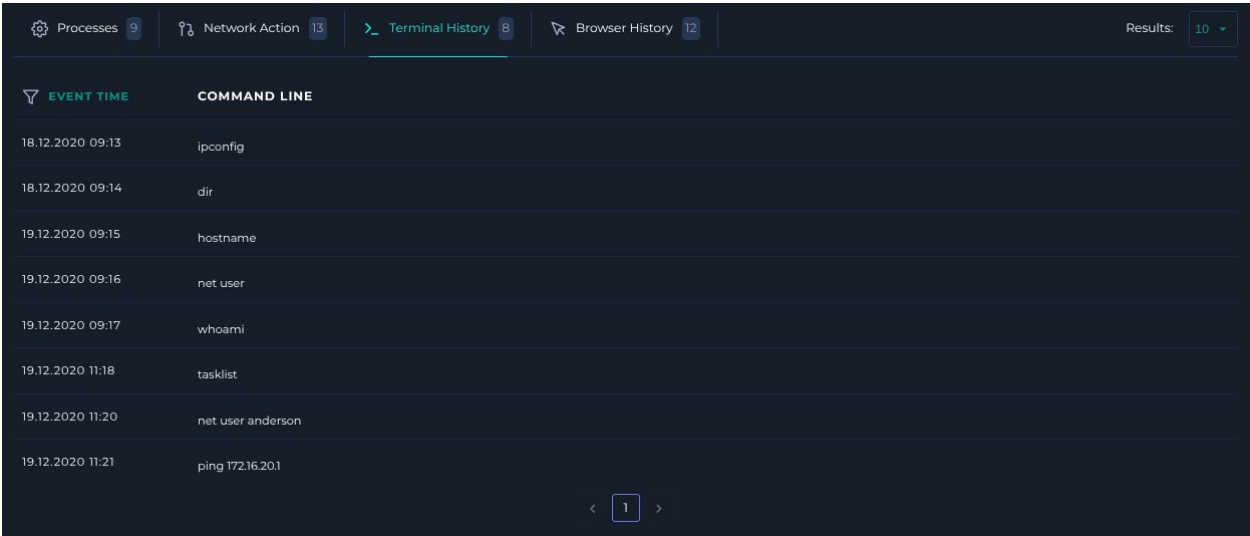
Event Information:

EventID :
71
Event Time :
Mar, 07, 2021, 04:50 PM
Rule :
SOC134 - Suspicious WMI Activity
Level :
Security Analyst
Source Address :
172.16.17.54
Source Hostname :
Desktop-Anderson
File Name :
exec.bat
File Hash :
50459310eded4c520ab5c9e3626a9300
File Size :
52.00 B
Device Action :
Allowed

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched with IP 172[.]16.17.54 hostname Desktop-Anderson as the source yielding 0 events.

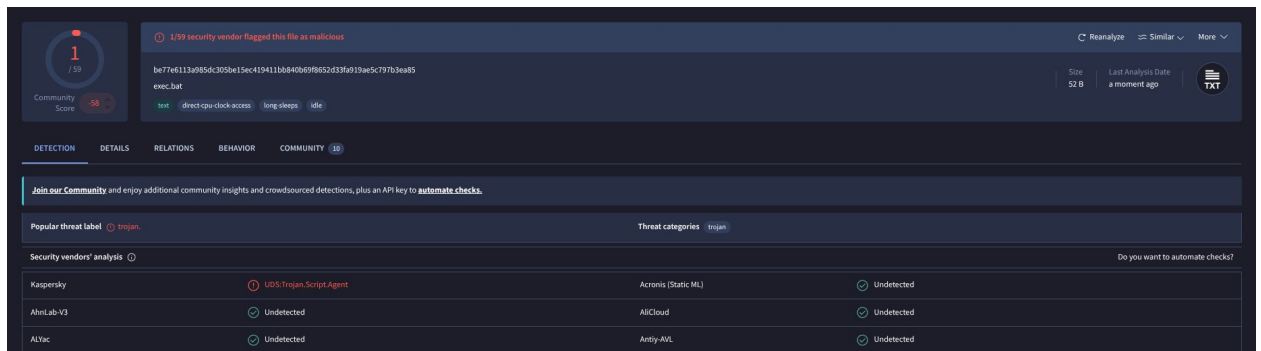
Nothing can be seen activating on the machine in the relevant time-frame.



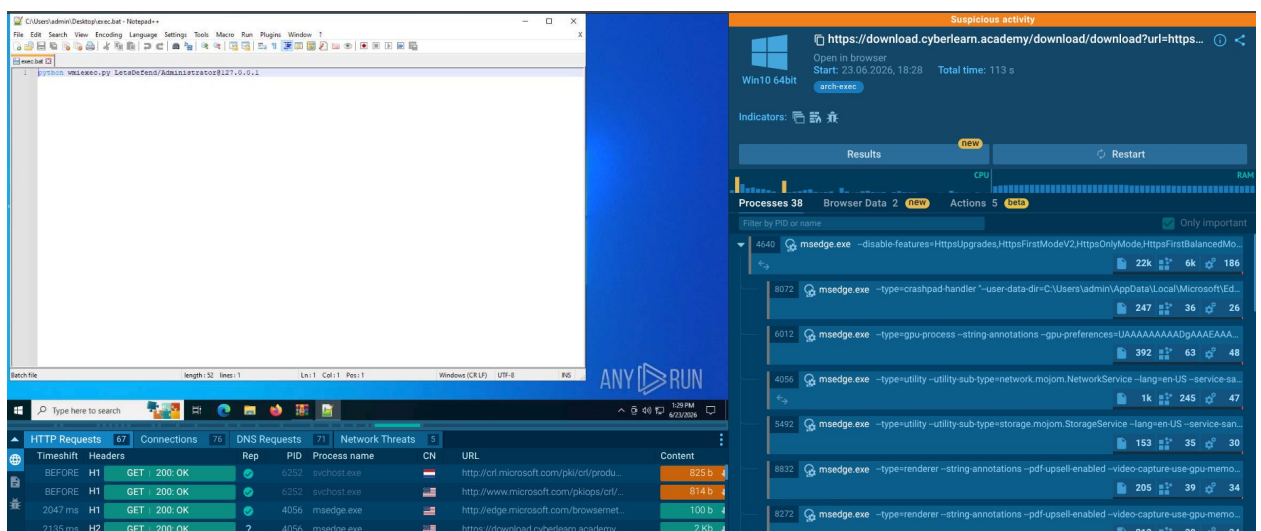
EVENT TIME	COMMAND LINE
18.12.2020 09:13	ipconfig
18.12.2020 09:14	dir
19.12.2020 09:15	hostname
19.12.2020 09:16	net user
19.12.2020 09:17	whoami
19.12.2020 11:18	tasklist
19.12.2020 11:20	net user anderson
19.12.2020 11:21	ping 172.16.20.1

The flagged binary is a WMI (Windows Management Instrumentation) is a built-in feature of the Windows operating system which is often used in LOL (Living off the Land) activities but also heavily in normal Windows operation. As such further investigation was required.

When searching for the flagged file on VirusTotal 1/59 Vendors listed the file as malicious.



However, on AnyRun the file is listed as suspicious and we can clearly see the malicious command being run.



The command being run is:

```
python wmiexec.py LetsDefend/Administrator@127.0.0.1
```

This indicates the script is being used to initiate a malicious C2 connection. Context is important as the tool and command themselves may be used for benign purposes.

Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a True Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary Analysis confirms a True Positive alert for suspicious WMI activity on the host Desktop-Anderson (172[.]16.17.54). The alert was triggered by the execution of a batch file (exec.bat). It was discovered to contain a command invoking wmiexec.py, a known component of the Impacket framework that can be utilised by threat actors for lateral movement and remote code execution via WMI.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC134 - Suspicious WMI Activity
- **Target Host:** Desktop-Anderson (172[.]16.17.54)
- **Flagged File:** exec.bat
- **File Hash:** 50459310eded4c520ab5c9e3626a9300

Analysis and Evidence

- **File Characteristics:** The flagged file is a 52-byte script. Raw content analysis reveals the exact command: `python wmiexec.py LetsDefend/Administrator@127.0.0.1`.
- **Attack Execution:** The command attempts to utilise the Python-based Impacket library (wmiexec.py) to authenticate as the local Administrator. This is a recognised "Living off the Land" technique used to facilitate remote command execution.
- **Tool Evasion:** Because the payload is a simple text command relying on external Python execution, heuristic antivirus engines failed to identify the destructive behaviour.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT:** VirusTotal analysis indicates a 1/61 detection rate. This high false-negative rate is consistent with script-based commands that do not contain compiled malware signatures.

Actions Taken

1. Identified the malicious use of the Impacket framework (wmiexec.py).
2. Declared the alert a True Positive.
3. Escalated alert for further analysis.

Let's Defend Result

SOC134 - Suspicious WMI Activity

True Positive (+5 Point)

Check If Someone Requested the C2 (+5 Point)

Analyze Malware (+5 Point)

Check if the malware is quarantined/cleaned (+5 Point)